

# CleanTech Open 2025: Scorer & Evaluation Manual

Step-by-step instructions for evaluating startup applications, utilizing the AI Due Diligence Copilot, and navigating founder deliverables with auto-citation jumping.

**Target:** Expert Judges, Mentors & Investors

**Portal URL:** `/index.html`

**Evaluation Framework:** 10 Categories (282 Criteria)

## 1 Getting Started & Logging In

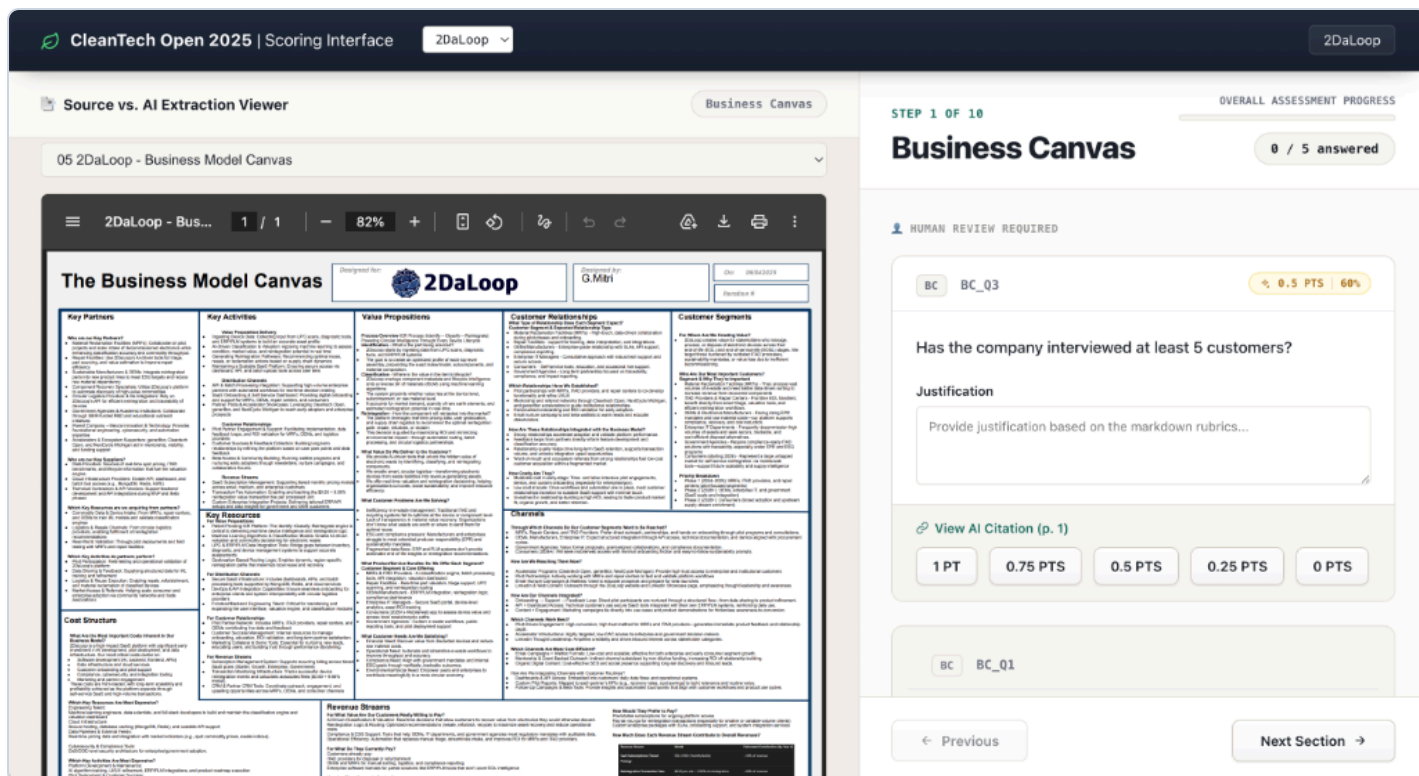
As a CleanTech Open judge, you have been assigned specific cleantech startups to evaluate. Your evaluations determine accelerator cohort admissions, awards, and investment readiness.

1. Navigate to the scoring portal at `/index.html`.
2. In the **Judge Authentication** modal, enter:
  - **Scorer ID:** Your assigned username (e.g., `judge_smith` or `J-001`).
  - **Passcode:** Your individual access passcode provided by the administrator.
3. Click **Sign In**.
4. In the top dark navigation bar, click the **Company Dropdown** to view the startups assigned to you. Select the startup you wish to evaluate to load its application workspace.

**Cloud Auto-Save:** Every score selection and justification note is **automatically saved to the Supabase database** the moment you click a score or pause typing. You can safely reload the page or return on another device without losing work.

## 2 The Split-Screen Evaluation Workspace

The CleanTech Open scoring interface features a high-velocity **Side-by-Side Split Workspace** designed to eliminate window tab flipping. The left panel is dedicated to original founder deliverables, while the right panel displays your active scoring rubric and AI guidance.



## Workspace Layout Overview

### LEFT PANEL: Source vs. AI Extraction Viewer

- **Deliverable Selector Dropdown:** Switch between any uploaded PDF for the active evaluation module (e.g., *05 2DaLoop - Business Model Canvas*).
- **Module Tag:** Displays current category context (e.g. Business Canvas).
- **Integrated PDF Viewer:** Complete in-browser document reader with zoom (+/-), page jump, rotation, pan, print, and local download.
- **Auto-Jumping Canvas:** Automatically snaps to the exact page when an AI citation is clicked on the right!

### RIGHT PANEL: Step-by-Step Scoring & Rubric

- **Module Step Indicator:** Shows current section (e.g., STEP 1 OF 10) and live progress (e.g., 0 / 5 answered).
- **Overall Assessment Progress Bar:** Visual progress tracking completion across all 282 criteria.
- **Evaluation Cards:** Scrollable criteria cards containing rubric text, AI suggestion pills, and point selectors.
- **Section Footer:** ← Previous and Next Section → buttons to transition between modules.

### 3 The AI Copilot & The Mandatory Human Review Rule



#### CRITICAL PROTOCOL: HUMAN REVIEW IS MANDATORY REGARDLESS OF AI CONFIDENCE

**Never rubber-stamp high-confidence AI suggestions.** An AI confidence rating of 90%, 95%, or 100% does **NOT** mean the startup's claim is commercially viable, technically sound, or factually true in the real world.

- **What AI Confidence Actually Measures:** The AI confidence score solely reflects *how clearly an explicit textual statement was found* in the founder's uploaded text. If a founder writes "Our technology has zero competitors and 100% customer retention", the AI will extract a high-confidence match (1.0 PT | 95% Conf).
- **What the AI Cannot Do:** The AI cannot verify whether the founder's claim is realistic, whether lab data supports it, whether customer interviews were genuine, or whether the competitive analysis is superficial.
- **Your Role as an Expert Judge:** You **must click the citation link**, review the cited passage in the PDF viewer on the left, inspect the surrounding context, and determine whether the startup genuinely satisfied the standard. **You have full authority to override the AI whenever founder evidence lacks depth or credibility.**

#### Anatomy of an Interactive Evaluation Card

Each evaluation card in the right panel is structured for rapid diligence and transparent accountability:

EVALUATION CARD BREAKDOWN

MODULE: BUSINESS CANVAS (BC)

HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

0.5 PTS | 60% Conf

BC BC\_Q3

Has the company interviewed at least 5 customers?

Justification

View Examples

Provide justification based on the markdown rubrics...

View AI Citation (p. 1)

05\_2DaLoop\_Business\_Model\_Canvas.pdf

"Interviews we've completed before (NSF I-Corps) indicates that enterprise IT managers require standardized SLA guarantees..."

Switched viewer to Page 1. Use **Cmd+F** / **Ctrl+F** in the viewer to locate exact text.

1 PT

0.75 PTS

0.5 PTS

0.25 PTS

0 PTS

## 4 The 10 Evaluation Categories

Judges evaluate startups across 10 standardized modules. Use the *Next Section* → and ← *Previous* buttons at the bottom of the right panel to move sequentially through each section:

| Code         | Module Title                    | Questions                  | Primary Deliverable(s) Reviewed in Left Panel                  |
|--------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| BC           | Business Canvas                 | 5 Questions (BC_Q1–Q5)     | Business Model Canvas (EBD1) & Customer Discovery capture      |
| ES           | Environmental & Social          | 10 Questions (ES_Q1–Q10)   | Impact Statement (EBD2) & Sustainability module questions      |
| F            | Financials                      | 29 Questions (F_Q1–Q29)    | 3-Year Financial Projections (EBD5) & unit economics model     |
| IP           | Investor Pitch                  | 58 Questions (IP_Q1–Q58)   | Investor Pitch Deck (EBD8) & full diligence slide presentation |
| IS           | Executive Summary               | 34 Questions (IS_Q1–Q34)   | 1-Page Executive Summary (EBD6) & core company narrative       |
| L            | Legal & Governance              | 53 Questions (L_Q1–Q53)    | IP filings, corporate formation, governance & legal review     |
| M            | Market & Customers              | 12 Questions (M_Q1–Q12)    | Customer Segmentation & Competitive Matrix (EBD3)              |
| PMF          | Product Market Fit              | 34 Questions (PMF_Q1–Q34)  | Customer interviews, discovery log & target customer segments  |
| T            | Team Targets                    | 31 Questions (T_Q1–Q31)    | Team hiring plans, targets & milestones                        |
| TP           | Tech / Product                  | 16 Questions (TP_Q1–Q16)   | Technology Validation (EBD4) & Technical testimonials          |
| <b>TOTAL</b> | <b>10 Evaluation Categories</b> | <b>282 Questions Total</b> | <b>Standardized CleanTech Open Diligence Rubric</b>            |

## 5 Step-by-Step Diligence Checklist

Follow this standardized 5-step workflow for every startup assigned to you:

| Step          | Action               | Description & Best Practice                                                                                                         |
|---------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Step 1</b> | Executive Summary    | Start in the <b>Executive Summary (IS)</b> category to read the founder's 1-page overview and understand the core thesis.           |
| <b>Step 2</b> | Category Progression | Progress systematically through the 10 categories using the bottom navigation buttons. Watch the overall progress bar fill.         |
| <b>Step 3</b> | Inspect Citations    | On each question, click " <b>View AI Citation</b> " to verify the founder's claim against the embedded PDF deliverable on the left. |
| <b>Step 4</b> | Record Score & Notes | Select your point verdict. If the question requires justification or if you disagree with the AI, type your brief explanation.      |
| <b>Step 5</b> | Final Verification   | Click " <b>Confirm &amp; Submit</b> " when prompted to finalize and flush all scores to the database.                               |

## 6 Scorer FAQs & Pro-Tips

### Frequently Asked Questions

**Q: What if the AI Citation says "No direct evidence exists"?**

**A:** This means the startup's submitted deliverables did not address this specific criterion. If you independently search the document and cannot locate evidence, award **0 PTS**.

**Q: Can I view the official rubric scoring guidelines?**

**A:** Yes! On questions with official rubric guidelines (e.g. Business Canvas), click the " **View Examples**" link in the question card to view rubric thresholds and real-world grading examples calibrated directly to the **0 – 1 point scale** (0, 0.25, 0.5, 0.75, 1.0 PTS).

**Q: How do I zoom or download a startup PDF?**

**A:** The live PDF viewer on the left includes full browser controls in the top toolbar: zoom in/out (+/-), page jump, and a direct download icon to inspect the file in your preferred PDF reader.

**Q: What if I notice a document misclassification?**

**A:** The deliverable dropdown above the PDF viewer allows you to switch between all documents attached to that category. If you need to view a deliverable from another category, navigate to that category section.

**Q: What happens if I close my browser before clicking Submit?**

**A:** All scores and justifications are continuously saved to the Supabase database in real time. When you reopen the portal, all your answers will automatically reload from the database.